A TRIBUTE TO

Laverne Fields Richardson

Dear *Mom*

A Love That Words Could Never Repay



WRITTEN WITH LOVE BY

Josh Jr. Richardson II

Dedication

To my mother, Laverne Fields Richardson—

a strong Black mother of six children, a woman of love, sacrifice, courage, and perseverance.

This book is for every late night, every meal, every gift, every hug, every lesson, and every time you kept going even when life was not easy.

You gave me a kind of love I could never repay. I hope these pages remind you that I see you, I honor you, and I love you.

Forever your son,

Josh Jr. Richardson II

Family Memories

These photographs preserve pieces of our family story—childhood, laughter, togetherness, and the people who helped shape us. They remind me that a mother’s love is not only spoken; it is seen in the moments she helps create and the memories her children carry.

A Letter Before the First Page

Mom, this book is my way of trying to put into words what my heart has carried for years. No book could ever measure the love you have given me, and no collection of sentences could repay the sacrifices you made. Still, I wanted to give you something that could stay with you—a reminder that your son sees you, appreciates you, and loves you.

You gave me life. You stood beside me while I was still learning how to stand on my own. You supported me through moments when I did not understand what I was doing or where life was taking me. You celebrated my joy, comforted me in difficult times, and corrected me when I needed direction. Every part of that helped shape the person I am becoming.

I hope these pages make you smile. I hope they bring back memories. Most of all, I hope they remind you that your love has never gone unnoticed.

A Strong Black Mother of Six

Mom, you are a strong Black mother of six children. That is not just a description; it is a story of commitment, patience, and perseverance. Raising six children means giving love in six different ways, meeting six different sets of needs, and continuing to show up even when you are tired or carrying worries of your own.

You were not only raising children. You were helping shape six lives. You were teaching us through your words, your choices, your discipline, and the way you continued to care for us. The strength it takes to be there for a family is not always loud or visible. Sometimes it looks like getting up and doing what needs to be done. Sometimes it looks like putting a child's needs ahead of your own. Sometimes it looks like keeping a promise or creating a little happiness in the middle of an ordinary day.

I hope you know that I see the woman behind the title of "Mom." I see your effort. I honor your resilience. I am proud to be your son.

The Love That Started My Story

Before I knew the world, you were already part of my story. You carried me, brought me into this life, and began loving me before I could understand what love meant. I could not thank you then. I could not understand the weight of your responsibility or the hopes you held for me.

As I grew, your love became part of the foundation beneath me. It was in your care, your encouragement, your hugs, your laughter, and the way you kept being my mother through every season. The older I get, the more I understand that a mother’s love is not one moment. It is a thousand moments, repeated day after day.

When I Was Too Young to Understand

There were times when I was a child and did not fully understand my own choices. I was still learning, still making mistakes, and still figuring out who I was. You were there through those trials and tribulations, even when I did not realize how much patience it took.

Looking back, I understand that your support did not mean you thought I was perfect. It meant you loved me while I was growing. You gave me room to learn, and you gave me guidance when I needed it. I may not have understood every lesson in the moment, but I carry the meaning of those lessons with me now.

The Christmas Nights I Will Never Forget

One of the memories I hold close is you wrapping Christmas presents late at night, all by yourself, making sure we would have a beautiful Christmas. As a child, I saw the gifts under the tree and felt the excitement of the morning. I did not always see the work that came before it—the time, the planning, the effort, and the love behind every wrapped present.

Now, that memory means more to me than the presents themselves. I picture you staying up while the house was quiet, making sure your children had something to look forward to. You were creating joy. You were making childhood feel special. You were giving us memories that would last long after the wrapping paper was gone.

Thank you for every Christmas you worked to make special. Thank you for the love hidden inside every gift.

Food, Care, and the Everyday Things

You kept bringing food and making sure we were cared for. Those everyday acts might have seemed small at the time, but they were part of a bigger message: you wanted us to be okay. You wanted us to have what we needed. You continued to show love through practical things, not only through words.

As children, we can grow accustomed to the care that surrounds us. We may not realize how much thought goes into a meal, a ride, a gift, or checking in. As adults, we begin to understand that love often looks like consistency. It looks like someone remembering what matters to you and continuing to show up.

Shopping Days and Childhood Joy

I remember you taking me and my sister shopping when I was in middle school. Those outings were more than a chance to get something new. They were time together. They were moments when I could feel your care in a simple, tangible way.

Some memories stay with us because of what happened; others stay because of how they made us feel. I remember the feeling of being looked after, of having you there, of sharing time that belonged to us. Those moments helped build the childhood I look back on today.

Love Through Change

Even after you and my father separated, you continued to take care of me. Changes in a family can be confusing for a child, and there are things children do not know how to ask or explain. Through those changes, you remained my mother. You continued to care for me and help me feel that I was loved.

I want you to know that I remember that. I remember the ways you kept going and the ways you continued to show up. The shape of a family can change, but a mother’s love can remain a steady place to return to.

The Hugs, Laughs, and Joy You Gave Me

When I think about you, I do not think only about the hard work. I think about the laughter, the hugs, and the joy. I think about the moments that made life feel lighter. Those memories matter because they remind me that our story is not only about sacrifice. It is also about happiness, closeness, and love.

Thank you for the times you made me laugh. Thank you for the comfort of your hugs. Thank you for the ordinary moments that became special simply because you were there.

Discipline Was Part of Your Love

You corrected me when I needed it. At the time, I may not have always understood why. Children often see only the rule or the consequence, not the concern behind it. With time, I have come to understand that discipline can be one way a parent tries to prepare a child for life.

Your guidance helped shape me. It reminded me that choices matter, that actions have consequences, and that growing up means learning. I may still have lessons to learn, but I can appreciate that you were trying to help me become stronger and wiser.

The Strength You Showed in Difficult Times

There are times in life when everyone feels weak, even the people we look to as strong. What I admire is the way you kept moving through difficult moments. You did not have to be perfect to be strong. You only had to keep finding a way forward.

I know I may never understand every challenge you faced. I cannot claim to know every worry you carried or every sacrifice you made quietly. But I can honor the fact that you continued to love and care for your children. Your strength has become part of the story I tell about where I come from.

A Family Built From Many Moments

A family is not made by one big event. It is built through years of small moments: meals, photographs, conversations, celebrations, lessons, and the times people gather in the same room. The family pictures included in this book are reminders of those moments.

When I look at them, I see more than faces in a frame. I see pieces of a life we shared. I see childhood, growing up, and the passage of time. I see memories that cannot be recreated exactly, but can be carried with us. Thank you for being part of the reason those memories exist.

What I Understand Now

As I get older, I understand more about what it means to raise children. I understand that love takes work. I understand that caring for a family requires time, patience, and sacrifice. I understand that some of the things I once thought were ordinary were actually gifts.

I wish I could go back and recognize every effort while it was happening. I wish I could thank you in the moment for every time you did something to make my life better. I cannot change the past, but I can tell you now: I see it, and I appreciate it.

Your Love Cannot Be Repaid

Mom, I can give you gifts, write you letters, and tell you that I love you, but I know I can never repay everything you have given me. A mother’s love is not a bill to be paid. It is a gift that becomes part of a child’s life.

I do not want this book to suggest that I could ever make us even. I want it to show that I recognize what you gave. I want you to know that your love has mattered, your work has mattered, and your presence has mattered. The best I can do is carry what you taught me and give love forward.

Six Children, One Powerful Legacy

Your legacy is not measured only in the things you bought or the days you worked. It is also in the lives you helped shape and the memories you helped create. As a mother of six, you have a story full of different personalities, different journeys, and different moments.

Each child carries their own memories of you. This book is my part of that story—my way of saying thank you for the mother you have been to me. I hope it reminds you that the love you gave continues to live beyond the years when we were small.

The Photographs That Hold Time

A photograph can hold a moment still even while life keeps moving. These pictures remind me of how much time has passed and how many chapters our family has lived. They bring back the feeling of being young, being together, and having memories that now mean even more because we cannot return to those exact days.

I am grateful we have these pictures. They give us something to look at when we want to remember. They help turn stories into something we can see. And they are part of the gift I wanted to include in this tribute to you.

A Thank-You for Every Little Thing

Thank you for the big things and the little things. Thank you for the things I noticed and the things I only understood later. Thank you for taking care of me, for guiding me, for making holidays special, for bringing food, for spending time with me, and for continuing to love me as I grew.

Thank you for not giving up on me when I was still learning. Thank you for being present through changes. Thank you for the moments of joy that became memories I can carry. I know I have not said every thank-you that you deserve, so let this book say some of them for me.

A Message to the Woman Behind the Title

Before you were known to me as Mom, you were a whole person with your own dreams, hopes, experiences, and strength. I hope life gives you opportunities to feel appreciated not only for what you do for others, but also for who you are.

You deserve kindness. You deserve rest. You deserve to hear that you have made a difference. You deserve to know that your son is grateful for you. I hope this book gives you a moment to sit back and receive some of the love you have spent so many years giving.

For Every Time You Stayed Strong

I honor the times you stayed strong for us. I honor the effort it took to keep caring, even when life demanded a lot from you. I honor the way you continued to create memories and show love.

Strength does not mean never feeling tired or sad. It means being human and continuing to find a way through. I hope you give yourself credit for what you have carried. I hope you can look at your life and see not only the challenges, but also the beautiful things you helped make possible.

The Lessons I Carry

Some lessons are spoken directly; others are learned by watching. From you, I learned that love can be shown through action. I learned that family matters. I learned that guidance and care can exist together. I learned that a person can make a difference through consistency, even when no one is applauding.

I will keep learning as I go through life, but the foundation you helped build will always be part of me. I hope I can use what you gave me to become a better person and to show others the same care and understanding.

A Love That Travels With Me

No matter where life takes me, I will carry the fact that I am your son. I will carry the memories of your love, the sound of laughter, the feeling of your hugs, and the lessons you taught me. Those things travel with me in ways no suitcase could hold.

The world may change, and I will continue to grow, but the place you hold in my life will always be special. Thank you for being part of my beginning and for continuing to matter in every chapter that follows.

A Mother’s Love Is a Home

Home is not only a building. Sometimes home is a person whose love makes you feel that you belong. A mother can create that feeling through care, consistency, and the memories she builds with her children.

When I remember you looking after us, making sure we had food, and creating Christmas mornings to look forward to, I remember the feeling of being cared for. Thank you for the ways you made home feel like more than a place. Thank you for the love that helped make it a feeling I could carry.

I See You, Mom

I see the sacrifices. I see the strength. I see the woman who raised six children and kept giving. I see the mother who continued to care for me through change and through the years when I was still trying to understand life.

I know there may be parts of your story I do not know fully. But I know enough to say that I appreciate you. I want you to feel proud of the love you have given and the family memories you helped create. I hope these words help you feel seen and celebrated.

The Gift of Being Your Son

Being your son is part of my story that I will always treasure. I am grateful for the life you gave me and for the care you gave after that first moment. I am grateful for the experiences that shaped me and the memories that still make me smile.

I cannot choose every part of my journey, but I can choose to honor the people who helped me get here. I choose to honor you. I choose to tell you that you matter. I choose to put my gratitude into words so that you can return to them whenever you need a reminder.

For the Days You Wondered If It Was Enough

If there were days when you wondered whether you were doing enough, I hope you can see the love reflected in these pages. A child may not understand every sacrifice while growing up, but that does not mean the sacrifice was wasted or forgotten.

The gifts, the meals, the outings, the hugs, the lessons, and the memories all became part of my life. They mattered. You mattered. Your effort mattered. I hope you never underestimate the impact of the care you gave.

The Meaning of the Family Album

This album is more than a collection of photographs. It is a reminder that our lives have been connected through years of moments. Some pictures make us laugh. Some make us pause. Some remind us how small we once were and how much life has changed since then.

I wanted the photographs to be part of this book because words alone cannot tell the whole story. The pictures let the memories speak beside the words. Together, they say: we were here, we shared these days, and the love between us is worth remembering.

My Promise to Remember

I promise to keep remembering the good you gave me. I promise to keep learning from the lessons you tried to teach. I promise not to take for granted the care that helped shape my childhood. I know no person is perfect, and no family story is made of perfect moments, but love deserves to be acknowledged.

When I look back, I want to do so with gratitude. I want to remember the ways you showed up. I want to carry forward the strength and care that have been part of my life because you are my mother.

A Love Bigger Than These Pages

This book has a beginning and an ending, but my love for you does not fit neatly between covers. There will always be more memories, more things to thank you for, and more ways I can tell you that you matter to me.

If these pages do anything, I hope they make you feel loved. I hope they remind you that your story has touched mine deeply. And I hope you know that even when I cannot find the right words, the love is still there.

A Letter to My Mother

Mom,

Thank you for giving me life and for loving me as I grew. Thank you for standing by me when I was too young to understand my own choices. Thank you for the gifts, the laughter, the hugs, the food, the shopping trips, the guidance, and the memories.

I will never forget picturing you wrapping Christmas presents late at night so that we could wake up to a special morning. I will never forget that even after life changed, you continued to take care of me. Those memories mean more to me now than I could have understood back then.

You are a strong Black mother of six children, and I am proud to call you my mom. I hope this book gives back even a little of the joy you have given me. I cannot repay your love, but I can honor it. I can say thank you. I can keep your lessons with me. And I can make sure you know that you are appreciated.

I love you more than these pages can explain. Thank you for being my mother.

Forever your son,

Josh Jr. Richardson II



Family memories: the people and moments that make a lifetime.



The joy of growing up surrounded by family.



Little moments that became lifelong memories.



A mother’s love is present in the memories we carry.



Siblings, laughter, and the beauty of childhood.



The years change, but family memories remain.



A mother’s care lives on through every generation.



The love that helped build a family.



A family portrait: one part of a much bigger story.



A lifetime of memories, held close with love.